PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Academics and Schools

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Date: October 3, 2025

To: PPS Board of Directors

CC: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

From: Kristina Howard, Senior Chief

Subject: 2024-25 Required Instructional Time and Exemption Board Report

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BACKGROUND

This report is informational only, with **no further action required by the Board at this time**. It provides an annual review of the 2024-25 instructional minutes compliance and outlines the proactive steps staff is taking to reinforce high school scheduling practices. It is important to note that should the Board have interest in further review of the potential exemptions detailed in the *For Future Consideration* section, this work points to planning for current and future school years.

Annually, this report is provided to the Board to review status on meeting the Division 22 Required Instructional Minutes (581-022-2320) for the prior school year. The requirements for instructional time in grades K-12 are: Grade 12 — 966 hours; Grades 9–11 — 990 hours; and Grades K–8 — 900 hours, with allowable exemptions.

There are essentially two key components to calculating the Required Instructional Time with the additional consideration of state-provided exemptions.

1. Each school district shall ensure that at least 92% of all students in the district and at least 80% of all students (who are not exempted from the calculation) at each school operated by the district **are scheduled to receive annually the following hours of instructional time**. This part of the rule primarily applies to the scheduling of high school students.
   (A) Grade 12 — 966 hours;
   (B) Grades 9–11 — 990 hours; and
   (C) Grades K–8 — 900 hours.
2. Review of **actual instructional time** achieved during the school year **per grade level**.
3. Review of and determination of state-provided exemptions.

2024-25 Instructional Minutes: All grade bands successfully met and exceeded the required instructional minutes for the 2024–2025 school year.

Grade Level(s)	State Required Instructional Time
Kindergarten	900
1st - 5th Grades	900
6th - 8th Grades	900
9th - 11th Grades	990
12th Grade	966

Regarding the scheduling of students with a full course load (*i.e.*, meeting the state-required instructional hours), our overall percentage meets the standard with an average of 83%. One school (Cleveland) was below 80% for the 2024-25 school year, at 79%.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

The relevant Oregon Administrative Rules (OAR) governing this report and the high school scheduling standard are:

- **OAR 581-022-2320 (Required Instructional Time):** This rule mandates the minimum annual instructional hours and includes provisions for district-wide scheduling compliance (**at least 92% of all students in the district and at least 80% of all non-exempt students at each school** must be scheduled to receive the required hours).
- **ODE 29-2018 Permanent Administrative Order/OAR 581-022-2320 (2)(a) (Student Exemptions):** This order allows for the exemption of certain high school students from the instructional time calculation, specifically those earning credits toward a diploma through accelerated learning classes (e.g., **Advanced Placement, International Baccalaureate,** or post-secondary courses).
- **OAR 581-022-2320 (6) (State-Provided Exemptions):** This subsection details district-level exemptions that can be included in the instructional time calculation upon local school board approval, such as up to **30 hours for staff professional development (PD)**.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

2024-25 Compliance Status

- **Instructional Minutes Achieved:** All grade bands successfully met or exceeded the required instructional minutes for the 2024–2025 school year.
- **Student Scheduling Compliance (80% Rule):** The district's overall percentage of students scheduled for a full course load meets the standard with an average of **83%**. However, **one school (Cleveland) fell below the 80% threshold** (at 79%) for the 2024-25 school year. This non-compliance triggers the need for corrective action.
- **Root Cause for Non-Compliance:** The primary difficulty in meeting the 80% threshold is fully scheduling 12th-grade students, particularly those engaged in accelerated or

unique opportunities (like AP and IB) who may be intentionally scheduled for fewer traditional courses.

Corrective Action Planning

We are committed to ensuring our system-wide practices allow for all students to be **fully scheduled** into courses that accurately reflect their four-year plans. To address this, we will engage in a **review of current scheduling practices** for grades 9-12, effective this fall. As a component of our corrective action plan, we will convene high school leaders and a broad team to inform **guidance and alignment**. It is also important to note, at this point in the 2025-26 school year, at least 80% of all students are scheduled to receive annually the following hours of instructional time.

For Future Consideration

For informational purposes, we note two specific state-provided exemptions permitted under OAR 581-022-2320 that could be considered for future Board approval:

1. Student Exemption for Accelerated Learning (OAR 581-022-2320 (1)(C))

The state allows districts to exempt students who are earning credits toward a diploma through accelerated learning classes, such as **Advanced Placement (AP) and International Baccalaureate (IB)**.

- **Illustrative Impact:** Had this specific allowable exemption been fully reviewed and approved for the 2024-25 school year, the percentage of scheduled students at Cleveland High School would have risen from 79% to **99%**, immediately resolving the concern about the 80% threshold without altering student schedules. Future consideration of this exemption would recognize high-rigor coursework and provide a clear mechanism for compliance.

2. Staff Professional Development Exemption for Calendar Flexibility (OAR 581-022-2320 (6))

One state-allowed exemption, provides districts an option to count up to **30 hours of staff professional development (PD)** as instructional time.

- **Compliance Safeguard:** Not intending to reduce instructional hours, approval of this exemption at a future date would provide a proactive tool and calendar flexibility mechanism for the district. By pre-approving the use of these hours as instructional time, the district gains a necessary buffer to absorb **unforeseen calendar interruptions** (e.g., weather-related closures or facilities issues). This measure ensures the district can maintain compliance with instructional minutes without resorting to extending the school year, which can necessitate significant, unplanned expenditures and logistical adjustments.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

The required annual report to the Board on instructional time standards is a matter of public record, ensuring transparency with the community. Community engagement for this item is provided through the opportunity for **public comment** at the Board meeting, allowing families, staff, and community members to provide input on the 2024-25 compliance status and the proposed exemptions for the corrective action plan. Further engagement will occur during the

implementation of the corrective action plan as the district reviews and updates high school scheduling practices.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

Timeline Action Fall 2024 (Immediately) Review and Corrective Action Implementation: Immediately engage in a **review of current scheduling practices for grades 9-12**, convene high school leaders and a broad team to inform guidance and alignment.

2025-26 School Year: Consider implications of allowable state-approved exemptions as noted above for Advanced Placement and International Baccalaureate as well and the state-approved calendar exemption for professional development.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

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CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

Ensuring compliance with state-mandated instructional time directly aligns with the Portland Public Schools 2022-2027 Board Goals and the priorities of the "Forward Together" Strategic Plan for Racial Equity, Inclusion and Excellence as well as our new District Continuous Improvement Plan.

ATTACHMENTS

A. "Unpack this OAR" - Required Instructional Time OAR 581-022-2320
B. 581-022-0102 Definitions